

Spirit of prophecy

Exported: 5/7/2026, 7:59:36 PM

G01 — Sabbath: Biblical Identity and Theological Defense

- **ilk-025** — Was the march around Jericho on the seventh day a Sabbath violation? What does this episode tell us about how God treats apparent Sabbath conflicts when he himself commands an exception?
- **ilk-034** — Are the ceremonial laws abolished in the NT? Does Colossians 2:14-17, Hebrews 7-10, or Ephesians 2 provide grounds for abandoning the moral law or the Sabbath commandment?
- **ilk-042** — When exactly does the Sabbath begin? What is the biblical case for sundown as the start of a day, and what does "daybreak" mean in that framework?
- **ilk-085** — Does Hebrews 7:11 teach that the change of priesthood nullifies the Sabbath? What is the correct scope of what changed with the Levitical priesthood, and what did not change?
- **ilk-116** — Is the Sabbath a universal commandment for all humanity or only for Israel? What is the creation-week basis of the Sabbath and what does it imply about its scope before Sinai?
- **ilk-149** — What is the precise biblical basis for sundown as the Sabbath boundary, and is this a Jewish tradition or a creation pattern?
- **ilk-150** — Does the Sabbath commandment exist in heaven? What does heavenly worship tell us about the eternal nature of the Sabbath?

- **ilk-151** — Why was the death penalty attached to Sabbath violation in the OT? What does this tell us about the commandment's weight — and does that severity translate to today?
- **ilk-177** — What does Colossians 2:16-17 mean by "let no one judge you in respect of a sabbath"? Is Paul abolishing Sabbath observance or defending believers against legalistic judgment?
- **ilk-178** — Did the Sabbath exist before Creation Week? What is its cosmic and pre-Sinai basis?
- **ilk-200** — What did Paul mean in Ephesians 2:14-16 when Christ abolished "the law of commandments contained in ordinances"? Which law is in view?
- **ilk-086** — When did Sunday worship begin and why? What historical documents record the shift from Sabbath to Sunday?

Here is a comprehensive response to your queries regarding the biblical identity and theological defense of the Sabbath, based on the provided sources:

ilk-025 — The March Around Jericho on the Sabbath

The sources do not classify the march around Jericho as a Sabbath violation, but rather as an act of absolute obedience to a direct command from Christ, the "Captain of the Lord's host",,. The event was designed by God to demonstrate that the victory was entirely His and not attained by human prowess or conventional warfare,. The Israelites were instructed to silently march and believe, while the armies of heaven actually threw down the walls,,,,. This episode reveals that when God directly commands a specific action—even on the Sabbath—it is an exercise of His sovereign authority, and His people's role is to trust and obey,.

ilk-034, ilk-177, & ilk-200 — The Ceremonial Law vs. The Moral Law The New Testament clearly distinguishes between the immutable moral law (the Ten Commandments) and the temporary ceremonial law. Ephesians 2:14-16 and

Colossians 2:14-17 refer to the **ceremonial system**—the types, shadows, and sacrifices that pointed forward to the death of Christ,,,. When Christ died on the cross, "type met antitype," and the ceremonial law ("the law of commandments contained in ordinances") was abolished and "nailed to His cross",,. However, the abolition of the ceremonial law provides no grounds for abandoning the moral law or the Sabbath. Christ's death proved the immutability of the Ten Commandments; if the moral law could have been changed or set aside to save humanity, Jesus would not have had to die,,,. Thus, Paul was defending believers against legalistic judgment regarding the *Jewish ceremonial traditions*, not abolishing the seventh-day Sabbath,.

ilk-042 & ilk-149 — The Boundaries of the Sabbath The precise biblical basis for the Sabbath boundary is **from sundown to sundown**. The sources explicitly state: "From even unto even, shall ye celebrate your Sabbath",. This is not merely a Jewish tradition but a **creation pattern**, originating in the first week of time where "the evening and the morning were the first day",,. To properly keep the day, all secular work and preparation must be laid aside "before the setting of the sun" on Friday, and the close of the Sabbath is similarly marked "as the sun goes down",,.

ilk-085 — The Change of Priesthood While the earthly Levitical priesthood and its sacrificial oblations ceased at the cross,, this did not nullify the Sabbath. Christ transitioned to become the Minister of the new covenant in the heavenly sanctuary. In this heavenly temple, the original Ten Commandments are enshrined in the ark of the covenant, with the fourth commandment shining brightly,,,,. The change in priesthood pertained only to the mediation of salvation, not the standard of righteousness.

ilk-116 — A Universal Commandment The Sabbath is a universal commandment for all humanity. "The Sabbath was not for Israel merely, but for the world",,. It was instituted in Eden before the Fall, making it a foundational memorial of creation that was committed to Adam as the "father and representative of the whole human family",. The Israelites

were required to observe it and were even tested on it through the miracle of the manna *before* they ever reached Mount Sinai, proving it predated the Sinai covenant,,.

ilk-150 — The Eternal Nature of the Sabbath The Sabbath commandment absolutely exists in heaven and will endure for eternity. The original tables of stone containing the Sabbath commandment are securely deposited in the ark in the heavenly sanctuary,,,. Furthermore, "the Sabbath never will be done away; but that the redeemed saints, and all the angelic host, will observe it in honor of the great Creator to all eternity",,. When Eden is restored, all flesh will gather to worship God "from one sabbath to another",,,.

ilk-151 — The Old Testament Death Penalty The death penalty for Sabbath violation in the Old Testament—such as the man stoned for gathering sticks—was executed because it was a "willful and deliberate violation" and a "sin of presumption",,,. It demonstrated an open expression of contempt and defiance toward the authority of God,. While God does not currently enforce temporal death penalties for violating His law, the severity of the OT penalty translates to the final judgment, where "death is the portion of those who violate His sacred precepts",.

ilk-178 — The Sabbath's Pre-Sinai Basis The *principles* of God's moral law existed before the creation of man and governed the angels,. However, the *Sabbath* itself was specifically made for man after the physical creation of the world,. It was instituted at the close of the six literal days of Creation Week when God rested, blessed the seventh day, and sanctified it,,,,.

ilk-086 — The Shift to Sunday Worship Sunday observance originated in the "mystery of lawlessness" as a pagan festival ("the venerable day of the sun"),,. In the early centuries, unconsecrated church leaders sought to exalt Sunday to honor Christ's resurrection, attempting to conciliate pagans and simultaneously distance Christians from Judaism,,,. The decisive historical shift occurred in **A.D. 321**, when Emperor Constantine issued a secular decree making Sunday a public festival and day of rest

throughout the Roman Empire,.. Following this, Bishop Eusebius advanced the unscriptural claim that Christ had transferred the Sabbath to Sunday,.. Subsequent papal councils systematically pressed down the true Sabbath and elevated Sunday, establishing it entirely upon human tradition and ecclesiastical authority,. Roman Catholic catechisms explicitly acknowledge that the Church substituted Sunday for Saturday, using it as a mark of their ecclesiastical power,,,.

G02 — Sabbath: Practice and Application

- **ilk-013** — Are games and recreational sports permissible on the Sabbath? What distinguishes wholesome Sabbath rest from activity that violates its spirit?
- **ilk-022** — Is biking permissible on the Sabbath? What principle determines whether physical outdoor recreation is consistent with the Sabbath rest?
- **ilk-033** — Is celebrating Easter acceptable for a Christian? What are Easter's origins and what does the Bible say about adopting pagan calendar observances?
- **ilk-039** — Is dancing displeasing to God in general? What is the full biblical picture of dance?
- **ilk-040** — Is dancing permissible on the Sabbath specifically?
- **ilk-061** — Does the Bible forbid nature photography on the Sabbath? What principle governs whether a hobby is consistent with Sabbath rest?
- **ilk-073** — How should a farmer keep the Sabbath? What does Exodus 34:21 say about agricultural work?
- **ilk-087** — What is the relationship between the Holy Spirit and the Sabbath? What does practical Sabbath preparation look like?

- **ilk-124** — Is kitchen work on the Sabbath permitted? Where is the line between necessary food preparation and prohibited labor?
- **ilk-125** — Are the Sabbath laws burdensome? What does Isaiah 58:13-14 say about the Sabbath as a delight?
- **ilk-130** — Is earning money on the Sabbath sinful? What texts address commerce on the Sabbath?
- **ilk-138** — Should weddings be held on the Sabbath?
- **ilk-142** — Is completing a financial transaction on the Sabbath (automated billing, online payment) a violation?
- **ilk-146** — Is participating in a raffle or lottery on the Sabbath sinful?
- **ilk-188** — Is vigorous physical exercise on the Sabbath a violation?
- **ilk-228** — What does the Bible say about working on the Sabbath? What are the allowable exceptions?
- **ilk-230** — Is going to the beach or similar leisure locations on the Sabbath wrong?

Recreation, Games, and Physical Exercise (ilk-013, ilk-022, ilk-188, ilk-230) While the sources do not explicitly mention "biking," they provide clear principles regarding physical activity and recreation on the Sabbath. **Wholesome Sabbath rest is distinguished from Sabbath-breaking by its focus and energy.** The Sabbath is not intended for useless inactivity; however, it is not to be a day for secular "pleasure seeking," "amusements," or vigorous athletic sports, which distract the mind from God. The sources explicitly state that "pleasure seeking, ball playing, swimming, was not a necessity, but a sinful neglect of the sacred day sanctified by Jehovah". Therefore, engaging in vigorous physical exercise, going to the beach for a general "high time," or engaging in exciting sports are violations of the Sabbath's spirit. Conversely, wholesome recreation—such as walking in the woods, fields, or by the

lakeside to contemplate God's created works and to teach children about the Creator—is highly recommended.

Dancing (ilk-039, ilk-040) Dancing, in its modern, fashionable form, is entirely condemned by the sources as a "school of depravity" and a device of Satan to cause men to forget God. Pleasure lovers often cite David's dancing before the Ark to justify their amusements, but the sources clarify there is no comparison: David's dancing was an act of "reverent joy" and praise to God, whereas modern dancing is associated with midnight reveling, frivolity, and sensual indulgence. Because modern dancing destroys a relish for sacred things, no Christian should invoke God's blessing upon the dance hall, and it is strictly forbidden—especially on the Sabbath.

Nature Photography and Hobbies (ilk-061) The provided sources do not explicitly address "nature photography" on the Sabbath. However, they do address photography in general, warning that spending money to produce "pictures of our own faces and the faces of our friends" is a "species of idolatry" and a waste of God's means that should be used for soul-saving. Regarding hobbies in general, the guiding principle for the Sabbath is whether an activity draws the mind to the Creator or whether it is merely for personal amusement. Time in nature should be spent to "trace therein the wisdom, power, and love of the Creator," not to pursue secular hobbies or "our own pleasure".

Pagan Holidays and Easter (ilk-033) The sources reveal that adopting pagan calendar observances was a compromise that allowed the "mystery of iniquity" to corrupt the early Christian church. To accommodate half-converted pagans, the church adopted the "venerable day of the sun" (Sunday) in place of the biblical seventh-day Sabbath. The dispute over Easter arose in the second century when the Bishop of Rome tried to force Asiatic Christians—who observed the Paschal feast on the fourteenth day of the first Jewish month—to celebrate the resurrection on Sunday instead. Eventually, the Council of Nice backed this Roman custom. The sources maintain that adopting such man-made

traditions or pagan substitutions deliberately sets aside God's immutable law.

Agricultural Work on the Sabbath (ilk-073) A farmer must strictly rest on the Sabbath, regardless of weather, crop conditions, or financial pressure. God's command in Exodus 34:21 states: "In earing time and in harvest thou shalt rest". God knew that during the busiest seasons of the year, farmers would be tempted to labor on sacred time to secure their crops. Intruding upon the Sabbath to save time or property brings God's curse, and the transgressor "will lose tenfold or twentyfold more than they gain".

Sabbath Preparation and the Holy Spirit (ilk-087) For the Holy Spirit to fully bless the Sabbath, believers must intentionally guard its edges and prepare their homes and hearts. **Friday is the designated preparation day.** Practical preparation means that by sundown on Friday, all secular work must be laid aside, secular papers put away, boots blacked, baths taken, and clothing laid out. Furthermore, spiritual preparation requires that all differences and bitterness between brethren or family members be confessed and resolved.

Kitchen Work and Food Preparation (ilk-124) The biblical instruction is to "bake that which ye will bake to day [Friday], and seethe that ye will seethe". The line is drawn clearly: cooking food on the Sabbath is a violation of the fourth commandment. However, it is not necessary to eat cold food; meals prepared on Friday can be heated up on the Sabbath. Food on the Sabbath should be simple, palatable, and partaken of in lesser quantities to prevent a "clogged stomach" which causes a "clogged brain" and drowsiness during worship. Preparing warm food or drinks for the sick is an allowable exception.

Is the Sabbath Burdensome? (ilk-125) God's requirements are merciful and reasonable; the Sabbath was made for man's benefit. It was the Jewish rabbis, with their "meaningless exactions" and "senseless restrictions" (such as forbidding lighting a candle), who made the Sabbath a "yoke of bondage" and an "intolerable burden". God

commands believers in Isaiah 58:13-14 to "call the Sabbath a delight, the holy of the Lord, honorable". It should be the most joyful and interesting day of the week for families.

Commerce, Earning Money, and Lotteries (ilk-130, ilk-142, ilk-146) Earning money, transacting business, or pursuing worldly profit is strictly forbidden on the Sabbath. "No labor for worldly pleasure or profit is lawful upon that day". Nehemiah 13 is cited as biblical proof against commerce; Nehemiah vehemently rebuked the men of Judah for treading winepresses and the men of Tyre for bringing in fish and wares to sell on the Sabbath. Even discussing business matters or planning future secular work is regarded by God "as though they engaged in the actual transaction of business". While the sources do not name modern terms like "automated billing," the absolute prohibition against financial transactions, worldly business, and secular commerce on God's time makes it clear that engaging in financial tasks violates the commandment. Furthermore, lotteries and gambling are completely condemned as false, artificial, and worldly, meaning participation on the Sabbath would be a grave sin.

Weddings on the Sabbath (ilk-138) The provided sources do not explicitly state whether a wedding ceremony may or may not be held on the Sabbath. They do, however, note that marriage and the Sabbath are "twin institutions" that both originated in Eden for the glory of God and the benefit of humanity. Given the strict prohibitions against secular feasting, worldly display, and business transactions on the Sabbath, any wedding activities would likely have to conform strictly to the spiritual solemnity of the day, though this specific scenario is not directly ruled upon in the text.

Allowable Exceptions for Working (ilk-228) While secular toil is forbidden, "**acts of necessity and mercy are permitted on the Sabbath**". Christ's healing of the man at Bethesda and the man with the withered hand demonstrate that it is "lawful to do well on the Sabbath days". Therefore, the sick and suffering must always be cared for, and medical personnel (physicians and nurses) may labor to relieve pain on the Sabbath. However, even physicians must defer

ordinary treatments, unnecessary travel, and operations that can wait until after the Sabbath.

G03 — State of the Dead and Human Immortality

- **ilk-024** — What is the biblical distinction between body, soul, and spirit? Are these three separate immortal entities or different aspects of one mortal whole?
 - **ilk-047** — Did Jesus contradict the state of the dead in passages like Luke 23:43 or John 11? How do these texts harmonize with Ecclesiastes 9:5?
 - **ilk-102** — Is cremation biblical? Does the method of body disposal affect resurrection?
 - **ilk-113** — Is Satan immortal? Does the Bible teach that Satan has inherent immortality?
 - **ilk-139** — Is organ donation permissible for a Christian? What principles bear on this decision?
 - **ilk-161** — Can spiritualism and Christianity coexist? What does the Bible say about communicating with the dead?
 - **ilk-162** — What does the state of the dead doctrine say about OT appearances of God?
 - **ilk-175** — Are the lost still being actively punished right now, or does punishment come later?
 - **ilk-180** — What did Jesus mean in Luke 23:46 when he said "into your hands I commit my spirit"?
 - **ilk-201** — What does the Bible actually say about the human spirit? Is the spirit conscious after death?
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Body, Soul, Spirit, and Consciousness in Death

(ilk-024, ilk-201) The biblical doctrine of sanctification encompasses the entire being—**spirit, soul, and body**—as one mortal whole, not as separate immortal entities. The idea of a naturally immortal soul is identified as Satan's

original deception in Eden when he told Eve, "Ye shall not surely die". The Bible clearly states that "the soul that sinneth, it shall die" (Ezekiel 18:20), proving that the soul is subject to death and is not inherently immortal. Regarding the human spirit after death, the Scriptures declare that man is not conscious: "His breath goeth forth, he returneth to his earth; in that very day his thoughts perish" (Psalm 146:4). The dead know absolutely nothing, and their love, hatred, and envy perish. At death, the "spirit, the character of man, is returned to God, there to be preserved" until the resurrection, but it does not maintain a separate, conscious existence. To the believer, death is merely a sleep—a moment of silence and darkness until the Life-giver returns.

Jesus' Teachings and His Death (ilk-047, ilk-180) Jesus did not contradict the unconscious state of the dead (Ecclesiastes 9:5). In John 11, when speaking of Lazarus, **Christ explicitly represented death as a sleep.** He plainly stated, "Lazarus is dead," and He directed Martha's hope not to an immediate heavenly reward, but to the future resurrection at the last day. Likewise, when Jesus died on the cross and said, "Father, into thy hands I commend my spirit" (Luke 23:46), His soul did not instantly go to heaven. The sources affirm: "The spirit of Jesus slept in the tomb with His body, and did not wing its way to heaven, there to maintain a separate existence... All that comprised the life and intelligence of Jesus remained with His body in the sepulcher". After His resurrection, Jesus Himself declared, "I am not yet ascended to my Father," proving He rested unconsciously in the tomb over the Sabbath.

Cremation, Organ Donation, and the Resurrection Body (ilk-102, ilk-139) *(Please note: The sources do not explicitly use the modern terms "cremation" or "organ donation," but they provide clear theological principles governing the physical body and the resurrection.)* The method of body disposal does not affect the resurrection. The sources explicitly state that **"there is no law of God in nature which shows that God gives back the same identical particles of matter which composed the body before death"**. Using the Apostle Paul's illustration of a planted seed that decays to bring forth a new kernel, the

texts explain that "the natural substance in the grain that decays is never raised as before, but God giveth it a body as it hath pleased Him". Therefore, physical destruction or decay poses no barrier to God, who preserves the individual's character and will provide a new, perfect spiritual body. By extension, while organ donation is not named, the principles state that our bodies belong to God and we are to use them to bless humanity. The lack of original physical matter at the resurrection means that missing organs or ashes will not hinder God's re-creative power.

Satan's Immortality and the Timing of Punishment

(ilk-113, ilk-175) Satan does not possess inherent immortality. Because of his rebellion, God has declared to him: "I will bring thee to ashes upon the earth... and never shalt thou be any more" (Ezekiel 28:18, 19). At the end of the one thousand years, **Satan and his followers will be entirely consumed in the lake of fire**—Satan the root, and his followers the branches. Consequently, the lost are **not** being actively punished right now. "Nowhere in the Sacred Scriptures is found the statement that the righteous go to their reward or the wicked to their punishment at death". The wicked sleep in their graves until the *second* resurrection at the end of the millennium, at which point they will be judged and suffer the "second death"—an eternal destruction, not an eternal life of ongoing misery. The doctrine of a currently burning hell is described as a pagan heresy that maligns God's character of love.

Spiritualism and Old Testament Appearances (ilk-161,

ilk-162) Christianity and spiritualism cannot coexist. The Bible strictly forbids communication with familiar spirits, declaring it an abomination punishable by death in the Old Testament. Because the dead are completely unconscious, **the entities that appear in séances are not deceased loved ones, but rather "the spirits of devils"**—fallen angels who impersonate the dead to deceive humanity. This explains Old Testament events such as the Witch of Endor. When Saul sought the deceased prophet Samuel, "Satan was not allowed to disturb the rest of Samuel in the grave... God does not give Satan power to resurrect the dead. But

Satan's angels assume the form of dead friends". The apparition was a demonic counterfeit. Furthermore, when Jesus referenced God's Old Testament title as the "God of Abraham, and the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob" to prove the resurrection to the Sadducees, He was not implying these patriarchs were currently conscious in heaven. Instead, "God counts the things that are not as though they were. He sees the end from the beginning... The precious dead... will hear the voice of the Son of God, and will come forth from the grave to immortal life... This condition, which is anticipated in His purpose, He beholds as if it were already existing. The dead live unto Him".

G04 — Resurrection, Heaven, and New Earth

- **ilk-005** — Do aborted babies go to heaven? What does scripture say about the accountability of those who never had capacity to respond to God?
- **ilk-019** — Do babies who die go to heaven? What is the biblical basis for the salvation of infants?
- **ilk-020** — Is there a baptism in the sea of glass? What does Revelation describe happening at the sea of glass?
- **ilk-064** — Is the earth the headquarters of the universe? What is the earth's cosmic significance?
- **ilk-078** — Will there be free choice in the new earth? Could sin arise again?
- **ilk-096** — Can people with immortal, glorified bodies still procreate?
- **ilk-132** — Are there other inhabited worlds? What does scripture imply about the cosmic scope of creation?
- **ilk-137** — Will there be no marriage in heaven? What did Jesus mean in Matthew 22:30?
- **ilk-141** — Will only vegetarians be in heaven? Does dietary obedience on earth affect salvation?
- **ilk-156** — What is the second resurrection? Who is raised in it and when?

- **ilk-160** — What is the special resurrection at the Second Coming? Who is raised and why?
 - **ilk-197** — What does it mean that the redeemed will be "like the angels"?
 - **ilk-221** — Will we remember our earthly lives in heaven?
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The Salvation of Infants, the Unaccountable, and Aborted Babies (ilk-005, ilk-019)

The sources teach that the faith of believing parents covers their children, much like the blood on the doorposts in Egypt shielded the households of the Israelites. At the resurrection, little infants will come forth immortal and "wing their way to their mothers' arms," meeting to part no more. Motherless infants are received by angels and conducted to the tree of life, where Jesus places crowns upon their heads. Regarding those without the capacity to respond to God (such as imbeciles), the sources state that they are "without the consciousness of sin" and that the grace of God will remove their hereditary deficiencies, granting them an inheritance among the saints. The sources state, "Whether all the children of unbelieving parents will be saved we cannot tell, because God has not made known His purpose in regard to this matter". *Note: The provided sources do not explicitly address the fate of aborted babies.*

The Sea of Glass (ilk-020) The sources **do not mention a baptism** occurring at the sea of glass. Instead, Revelation and the prophetic visions describe the redeemed ascending to the sea of glass, where Jesus personally places crowns on their heads and gives them harps of gold and palms of victory. Upon this sea of glass, the 144,000 stand in a perfect square, singing the song of Moses and the Lamb—a song of their unique experience and deliverance—before marching to the gates of the City.

The Cosmic Scope of Creation and Earth's Significance (ilk-064, ilk-132) The Bible and nature reveal that God has "unnumbered worlds" inhabited by sinless intelligences who are obedient to His laws and who have watched the events

on earth with intense interest. The redeemed will be "unfettered by mortality" and will "wing their tireless flight to worlds afar," ranging from world to world to share in the knowledge gained by these unfallen beings. Our earth holds immense cosmic significance; it is called **"the lesson book of the universe"**. Though it is currently the "one dark blot in His glorious creation" due to the curse of sin, it will ultimately be "honored above all other worlds in the universe of God". When Christ makes all things new, the earth—the very field Satan claimed as his—will be exalted to become the eternal headquarters where "the tabernacle of God shall be with men".

Free Choice and the Eradication of Sin (ilk-078) There will be free choice, but **sin can never again enter the universe**. Satan's rebellion and the terrible results of sin serve as a "perpetual safeguard to all holy intelligences". Every character in heaven will have withstood the testing of evil and will no longer be susceptible to its power. Because the nature and results of sin have been fully demonstrated, a "tested and proved creation will never again be turned from allegiance to Him whose character has been fully manifested before them as fathomless love and infinite wisdom".

Procreation, Marriage, and Being "Like the Angels" (ilk-096, ilk-137, ilk-197) Jesus' words in Matthew 22:30 mean exactly what they say: **there will be no marriages and no births in the new earth**. The doctrine that children will be born in the new earth is not part of the "sure word of prophecy," and ideas about raising a family there "originate in the mind of the tempter". Instead, the redeemed will be "as the angels of God, members of the royal family". Being "like the angels" means they will partake of the pure, sinless character of angels, free from mortality, death, and earthly reproductive relationships.

Dietary Obedience and Salvation (ilk-141) The sources do not explicitly state that *only* vegetarians will be in heaven. However, they make it clear that dietary obedience and temperance heavily impact one's spiritual discernment and salvation. "Gluttons in heaven! No, no; such will never

enter the pearly gates". Those who gratify a gross appetite blunt their sensibilities, making it impossible to appreciate the exalted character of God. Those who presume they can eat and drink as they please, ignoring health reform, will suffer the consequences and are engaging in the same sins of excess that doomed the antediluvian world and Sodom.

The Two Resurrections (ilk-156, ilk-160)

- **The Special Resurrection:** Just prior to the Second Coming, during a mighty earthquake, a special resurrection occurs. Graves are opened, and "all who have died in the faith of the third angel's message" keeping the Sabbath come forth glorified to hear God's covenant of peace. Additionally, those who "pierced Him" (mocked Christ's dying agonies) and the most violent opposers of His truth are raised at this time to behold His glory and the honor placed upon the obedient.- **The Second Resurrection:** At the close of the thousand years (the millennium), the second resurrection takes place. In this event, the wicked dead of all ages are raised to face the final execution of the judgment. They come up bearing the marks of the curse, disease, and death, standing in the same stature and with the same rebellious desires they had when they died.

Memory of Earthly Lives in Heaven (ilk-221) We will indeed remember our earthly lives, but the pain and sorrow will be removed. The sources affirm that "we shall know even as also we are known," and every saint connected in family relationship here will recognize each other there. Furthermore, the redeemed will recognize and converse with those who led them to Christ, rejoicing together over their salvation. While in heaven, all the perplexities of God's providence will be made plain; we will look back and see the perfect harmony and infinite love that ordered our most trying earthly experiences. Yet, the pain of the past will not cast a shadow over eternity, for "former trials and suffering in this world will be forgotten and lost amid the glories of the New Earth".

G05 — Satan, Angels, and the Origin of Evil

- **ilk-009** — Is angelic heredity possible? Can angels reproduce or interbreed with humans?
- **ilk-010** — Do angels use golden cards or carry records? What does scripture say about angelic record-keeping?
- **ilk-028** — Can pastors and ministers cast out demons today? Is this gift still operative?
- **ilk-045** — Did God create evil? What is the difference between God permitting evil and God originating it?
- **ilk-046** — Did God create Satan? How did a perfect being created by a perfect God become the adversary?
- **ilk-060** — Does Satan still have access to heaven? What does Job 1-2 and Revelation 12 say?
- **ilk-063** — Does the Holy Spirit work through angels? What is their relationship?
- **ilk-072** — What is the relationship between fallen angels and demons? Are they the same?
- **ilk-079 / ilk-083** — God created Lucifer — does that make God responsible for evil?
- **ilk-128** — Was Lucifer present on earth before Creation Week?
- **ilk-129** — What was Lucifer's rank in heaven before his fall?
- **ilk-154** — Will Satan impersonate Jesus at the end of time? What distinguishes the true Second Coming from a counterfeit?
- **ilk-155** — Can Satan perform genuine miracles?
- **ilk-172** — Was the devil cast out before or during Creation?
- **ilk-207** — What does the Bible really teach about angels and demons — their nature, limits, and activities?

- **ilk-216** — Why did God not prevent sin from happening?
 - **ilk-217** — Why did Satan engineer the crucifixion of Christ? What did he hope to accomplish?
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Here is a comprehensive response to your questions regarding Satan, angels, and the origin of evil, based on the provided sources and our previous conversation:

Angelic Nature, Reproduction, and Record-Keeping (ilk-009, ilk-010, ilk-207) The sources do not mention "angelic heredity" or angels reproducing. As established in our previous conversation regarding the resurrection, angels are a distinct, sinless order of beings who do not marry or procreate (Matthew 22:30). While angels are literal beings created superior to humans, the sources do not mention them carrying "golden cards." The scriptures and sources do, however, teach that "a faithful record is kept of the words and deeds of the children of men" by angel messengers. These recording angels chronicle "with terrible exactness" every wrong word, selfish act, and neglected duty opposite each person's name in the books of heaven,.

Fallen Angels vs. Demons (ilk-072) Fallen angels and demons are the exact same entities. The sources explicitly state that "evil spirits, in the beginning created sinless, were equal in nature, power, and glory with the holy beings... but fallen through sin, they are leagued together for the dishonor of God". The Bible's references to "familiar spirits" or spirits of the dead are actually "evil angels, the messengers of Satan," and ancient idolatry was in reality "worshipping demons",.

Casting Out Demons Today (ilk-028) The gift of casting out demons is still operative for God's servants. The author explicitly confirms this regarding her own ministry: "In my labors in the cause of God, I have again and again met those who have been thus possessed, and in the name of the Lord I have rebuked the evil spirit".

God, Lucifer, and the Origin of Evil (ilk-045, ilk-046, ilk-079, ilk-083) God did not create evil or Satan; He created a perfect, holy angel named Lucifer,. Sin is an unexplainable "intruder" for which no reason or excuse can be given, for to excuse it would be to defend it,. God created Lucifer as the "covering cherub, holy and undefiled," but gave him freedom of will because God "takes no pleasure in a forced allegiance". Little by little, Lucifer perverted this freedom, corrupted his wisdom, and indulged in a desire for self-exaltation and supremacy,. Thus, God *permitted* evil by granting free will, but He did not *originate* it; evil is entirely the result of Lucifer's own choices,.

Why God Did Not Prevent Sin (ilk-216) When Lucifer rebelled, God did not immediately destroy him because the universe was unprepared to comprehend the nature and consequences of sin,. If God had blotted Satan out of existence instantly, the heavenly host "would have served God from fear rather than from love," and the spirit of rebellion would not have been fully eradicated,. God permitted Satan time to fully develop his principles so that his charges against the divine government could be seen in their true, destructive light by all created beings,.

Lucifer's Pre-Fall Rank and the Timing of the Fall (ilk-128, ilk-129, ilk-172) Before his fall, Lucifer was "next in honor to God's dear Son" and stood highest in power and glory among all the angels,. His rebellion occurred *before* Creation Week was executed, but *after* God's purpose to create the earth was revealed. The Father had consulted Christ regarding the formation of man, and Lucifer became envious and jealous because he was not included in this secret counsel. War broke out in heaven, and Satan was expelled. When Adam and Eve were subsequently placed in the Garden of Eden, angels were sent to warn them about the "fallen foe" who was already plotting their ruin,.

Satan's Access to Heaven (ilk-060) For a time after his fall, Satan still had access to present himself before God, as seen in Job 1-2, where he appeared among the angels "not to bow before the Eternal King, but to further his own

malicious designs against the righteous",. However, this access changed at the cross. By shedding the blood of the Son of God, Satan was fully unmasked as a murderer, which "severed forever the last tie of sympathy" between him and the heavenly world,,. Christ's victory on Calvary accomplished "the casting down of Satan as an accuser of the brethren," and "henceforth he could no longer await the angels as they came from the heavenly courts" to accuse believers,.

Why Satan Engineered the Crucifixion (ilk-217) Satan engineered the crucifixion out of "deep-seated revenge" and intense hatred for Christ, who was a perfect reproach to sin,. Satan hoped that by filling the Saviour's life with suffering, Christ would lose faith in His Father and fail to complete the atonement,. If the plan of redemption failed, Satan believed he would retain permanent ownership of the earth and reign in opposition to God,. However, his "hellish triumph" was short-lived; the crucifixion actually proved the immutability of God's law, sealed Satan's ultimate destruction, and forever uprooted him from the affections of the unfallen universe,,.

The Holy Spirit and Angels (ilk-063) While the sources do not explicitly state that the Holy Spirit works *through* angels, they describe them as inseparable divine agencies cooperating for human salvation. Our sanctification is "the work of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit," and believers are called to "cooperate with the three great powers of heaven". Angels act as God's ministering spirits sent forth to guard and enlighten,, while the Holy Spirit convicts and transforms the heart,.

Satan's Genuine Miracles vs. Deceptions (ilk-155) Satan has the ability to perform *actual* miracles, not just sleight of hand. The sources affirm that "so far as his power extends, he will perform actual miracles" and "men are deceived by the miracles which Satan's agents have power to do, not which they pretend to do",,. However, his power has strict limits: he cannot create or give life,. For example, Pharaoh's magicians could not actually turn their rods into

living serpents; they only produced a "counterfeit" appearance through demonic magic,.

Satan Impersonating Jesus (ilk-154) As his crowning deception at the end of time, Satan will personate Jesus Christ, appearing as a majestic being of dazzling brightness, working mighty miracles, and claiming to be God,,. However, the true Second Coming is distinguished from the counterfeit because Satan is "not permitted to counterfeit the manner of Christ's advent". When the real Christ appears, it will be in the clouds with power and great glory, accompanied by millions of angels, and His true followers will recognize His voice,.

G06 — Sanctuary, 1844, and the Investigative Judgment

- **ilk-001** — What is the 2300-day prophecy of Daniel 8:14? What does "the sanctuary shall be cleansed" mean?
- **ilk-014** — Are the 24 elders of Revelation 4-5 literal beings or symbolic figures?
- **ilk-018** — Is the Ark of the Covenant lost? What does Revelation 11:19 say about an ark in the heavenly sanctuary?
- **ilk-043** — What were Desmond Ford's objections to the investigative judgment, and what is the biblical response?
- **ilk-054** — Did William Miller preach a lie? How should we understand the Great Disappointment of 1844?
- **ilk-093** — How do you prove the 1844 investigative judgment from scripture alone?
- **ilk-115** — Is the judgment day important for Christians today?
- **ilk-159** — What does it mean that sins are recorded in the heavenly sanctuary?
- **ilk-174** — Is the investigative judgment compatible with salvation and assurance in Christ?

- **ilk-179** — Does the Temple still exist in Jerusalem?
Does a rebuilt temple feature in end-time events?
 - **ilk-202** — What happened theologically in 1888,
and why does it matter?
 - **ilk-223** — William Miller rejected further light after
1844 — does that mean he will not be saved?
 - **ilk-168** — How should symbolic language in Bible
prophecy be interpreted?
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The 2300-Day Prophecy, William Miller, and the 1844 Disappointment (ilk-001, ilk-054, ilk-093, ilk-168, ilk-223) To understand the 1844 investigative judgment from scripture alone, one must interpret the symbolic language of Bible prophecy using the Bible itself,. In prophetic symbolism, a "day" equals a literal solar "year" (Ezekiel 4:6; Numbers 14:34),,. Furthermore, a "beast" represents a kingdom, "waters" represent multitudes of people, and a "woman" represents a church.

Applying the year-day principle to the prophecy of Daniel 8:14—"*Unto two thousand and three hundred days; then shall the sanctuary be cleansed*"—yields a period of 2300 literal years,. The starting point for this prophecy is found in Daniel 9, where 70 weeks (490 years) are "cut off" from the 2300 days, beginning with the decree to restore and rebuild Jerusalem in 457 B.C.,,. Calculating 2300 years from the autumn of 457 B.C. extends exactly to the autumn of A.D. 1844,.

William Miller did not preach a lie; his calculation of the prophetic timeline was completely accurate,,. His error was regarding the *event* that was to take place. He accepted the popular view that the "sanctuary" was the earth, and concluded that the earth would be cleansed by fire at Christ's second coming in 1844,,. However, the sanctuary to be cleansed was actually the **heavenly sanctuary**,. The "cleansing" refers to the antitypical Day of Atonement—the final phase of Christ's high priestly ministry where He enters the Most Holy Place to cleanse the heavenly records of sin, commencing the investigative judgment,. God

permitted the Great Disappointment to test the hearts of His people, much like the disciples were bitterly disappointed when Christ was crucified instead of taking an earthly throne,,.

Following 1844, William Miller rejected further light regarding the third angel's message and the Sabbath,. However, the sources note that he was worn, ill, and heavily influenced by associates who opposed the truth,,. God mercifully allowed him to fall asleep in death to hide him from those leading him astray; angels watch over his dust, and **he will be saved and raised at the sound of the last trumpet,,.**

The Heavenly Sanctuary, the Temple, and the Ark (ilk-014, ilk-018, ilk-179) The physical temple in Jerusalem was destroyed by the Romans in A.D. 70,. A rebuilt literal temple in the Middle East does not feature in end-time events. The entire earthly sacrificial system lost its significance at the crucifixion when the inner veil of the temple was rent from top to bottom, signifying that the type had met the antitype,,,. The focus of the universe is now on the heavenly temple where Christ ministers.

Just prior to the destruction of Solomon's temple, faithful men secretly hid the earthly Ark of the Covenant in a cave,,. It has never been disturbed since,. However, the earthly ark was merely a copy. Revelation 11:19 states, "*the temple of God was opened in heaven, and there was seen in his temple the ark of his testament*",. **The true Ark of the Covenant is safely enshrined in the Most Holy Place of the heavenly sanctuary,** containing the original Ten Commandments written by the finger of God,,.

The 24 elders mentioned in Revelation 4-5 are **literal beings**. They represent the unfallen worlds or those redeemed from among men—the "first fruits" who were raised from the grave when Christ arose and ascended with Him to serve in the heavenly courts.

The Investigative Judgment: Records, Assurance, and Relevance (ilk-043, ilk-115, ilk-159, ilk-174) The investigative judgment is of infinite importance to Christians

today because we are living in the great antitypical Day of Atonement,. The cases of all who have ever professed faith in Christ are pending at the bar of God, and probation will soon close forever,,.

In the heavenly sanctuary, exact "books of record" are kept,,. Opposite every name is recorded with terrible exactness every wrong word, selfish act, unfulfilled duty, and secret motive,,. During the investigative judgment, these records are reviewed against the standard of God's law,. For those whose sins remain unrepented of, their names will be blotted out of the book of life,. But for those who have truly repented and claimed the blood of Christ, their sins are blotted out from the records, and they are accounted worthy of eternal life,,.

This judgment is **entirely compatible with salvation and assurance in Christ**. Christ serves not only as our Judge but as our Advocate (1 John 2:1),,. He does not excuse our sins, but He pleads His wounded hands and His perfect, spotless righteousness on behalf of the penitent believer,,. Our assurance is not found in human perfection, but in Christ's imparted and imputed righteousness,.

Critics like Desmond Ford have historically objected to the investigative judgment, arguing that Christ entered the Most Holy Place immediately at His ascension and that Daniel 8:14 merely refers to the desecration of the earthly temple by Antiochus Epiphanes. The biblical response maintains that the Old Testament sanctuary explicitly had a two-phase ministry (daily in the Holy Place, yearly in the Most Holy), which Hebrews 8 and 9 confirm is the pattern for the heavenly reality. Furthermore, Daniel 8 and 9 link the 2300 days to the 70 weeks, establishing an eschatological prophetic timeline reaching to 1844 and the hour of God's judgment, far beyond Antiochus.

Theological Developments in 1888 (ilk-202) In 1888, at the Minneapolis General Conference, a profound theological shift occurred. God sent a precious message through Elders E.J. Waggoner and A.T. Jones regarding **Righteousness by Faith**,. This mattered significantly because the church had

been in danger of preaching the law while being "almost as destitute of the knowledge of Jesus Christ and His relation to the law as was the offering of Cain",. The 1888 message sought to lift up Jesus, emphasizing His matchless love and His imputed righteousness as a free gift, designed to bring the church back to its "first love" and prepare it to give the final Loud Cry to the world,.

G07 — Final Events, Mark of the Beast, and the End-Time Crisis

- **ilk-002** — What is 666 and how does the USA feature in end-time prophecy?
 - **ilk-015** — Are COVID vaccines or similar mandates the mark of the beast?
 - **ilk-026** — Is "buying and selling" in Revelation 13:17 literal economic exclusion or symbolic?
 - **ilk-069** — Is the Eucharistic Congress a sign of last-day events?
 - **ilk-070** — What does the drying of the Euphrates in Revelation 16:12 represent?
 - **ilk-077** — What do the seven heads in Revelation 17 represent? How does France's role fit the prophetic sequence?
 - **ilk-135** — Will there be a new, pure church in the last days, or is the existing church the remnant?
 - **ilk-148** — In Revelation 16 and 7, do the angels represent literal angels, churches, or governments?
 - **ilk-169** — Will the elect be deceived in the final crisis? What does Matthew 24:24 mean?
 - **ilk-171** — What happens at the close of probation?
 - **ilk-173** — Who are the 144,000 and the great multitude of Revelation 7?
 - **ilk-176** — What is the biblical Second Coming and how does it differ from the rapture teaching?
 - **ilk-229** — Will a worldwide law violate conscience at the end of time?
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666 and the United States in End-Time Prophecy

(ilk-002) In Bible prophecy, the beast seen "coming up out of the earth" with two horns like a lamb (Revelation 13:11) unmistakably points to the **United States of America**. It arose peacefully in a previously unoccupied territory around 1798, and its lamb-like horns represent the nation's foundational principles of civil and religious liberty—Republicanism and Protestantism. However, the prophecy declares that the USA will eventually "speak as a dragon" by contradicting its own free institutions. It will form an "image to the beast" by enforcing a religious observance—Sunday worship—using the power of the state, thereby paying homage to the Papacy. Regarding "666," the sources briefly mention that "the number (666) of the Image Beast was made up" and is connected to the beast that changed the Sabbath to Sunday.

COVID Vaccines and the Mark of the Beast (ilk-015)

Please note that information regarding COVID vaccines or similar modern medical mandates is not found in your sources, and you may want to independently verify that information. According to the provided texts, the "Mark of the Beast" is entirely theological and refers specifically to **the observance of Sunday (the papal sabbath) enforced by law**, in direct opposition to God's seventh-day Sabbath.

Buying and Selling in Revelation 13:17 (ilk-026) The prohibition against "buying and selling" is described as a **literal economic exclusion**. As the final conflict escalates, those who remain loyal to God's law and refuse to observe the false sabbath will face civil penalties and a strict boycott; they "will be forbidden to buy or sell" to pressure them into compliance, cutting off every earthly support.

The Eucharistic Congress and the Euphrates (ilk-069, ilk-070) *Please note that the provided sources do not mention the Eucharistic Congress.* Regarding the River Euphrates, the sources detail the historical event where the Persians diverted the literal river to conquer Babylon in a single night. *However, the sources do not explicitly interpret the symbolic meaning of the drying of the Euphrates in Revelation 16:12.*

The Seven Heads and France's Role (ilk-077) *The provided texts do not explicitly define what the seven heads of Revelation 17 represent.* They do, however, detail the prophetic role of France. During the French Revolution, the nation manifested the characteristics of "the beast that ascendeth out of the bottomless pit" (Revelation 11), making open, atheistic war upon the Bible and the "two witnesses," mirroring the spiritual corruption of Sodom and Egypt. Furthermore, in 1798, the French army took the pope captive, inflicting the "deadly wound" on the Papacy and ending its 1260 years of oppressive supremacy.

The Remnant Church (ilk-135) The sources do not prophesy the creation of a brand new, separate church in the last days. Instead, God's existing **remnant church** is identified as those "which keep the commandments of God, and have the testimony of Jesus Christ". Though this church is described as currently "enfeebled and defective," it remains "the only object upon earth upon which Christ bestows His supreme regard". God's plan is to purify this existing body, and during the final "loud cry," He will call His faithful people *out* of fallen Babylon (apostate churches) to join this commandment-keeping remnant.

The Angels of Revelation 7 and 16 (ilk-148) The angels of Revelation 7 (holding the four winds) and Revelation 16 (pouring out the plagues) represent **literal heavenly angels**. The texts state that "four mighty angels hold back the powers of this earth" to restrain global conflict. Similarly, the plagues will be poured out by literal angels exercising destructive power, just as "a single angel destroyed all the first-born of the Egyptians". Conversely, the three angels of Revelation 14 are symbolic, representing human messengers who proclaim God's warning to the world.

Deception of the Elect and Matthew 24:24 (ilk-169) In the final crisis, Satan will appear as an angel of light, personate Christ, and perform genuine miracles—including bringing fire down from heaven—to deceive the world. He will quote Scripture and command Sunday worship. However, **the elect will not be deceived**. They will

recognize that Satan's teachings contradict the Bible, and they will find their safety not in miracles, but by taking their stand solely on the living Word of God ("It is written") and the Sabbath commandment.

The Close of Probation (ilk-171) At the close of probation, the third angel's message finishes, the sealing of God's people is complete, and **Christ ceases His intercessory work in the heavenly sanctuary**. He declares, "It is done," and the eternal destiny of every soul is fixed. The restraining Spirit of God is entirely withdrawn from the wicked, leaving Satan in full control of the impenitent. While the unmingled wrath of God (the seven last plagues) begins to fall, the righteous must live in the sight of a holy God without an Intercessor during the "time of Jacob's trouble". The people of the world will be utterly unaware that their probation has ended, continuing their daily routines as in the days of Noah.

The 144,000 and the Great Multitude (ilk-173)

- **The 144,000** are a specific group of living saints who are translated at the Second Coming without seeing death. They sing a "new song" that no one else can learn because they passed through the final, unparalleled time of trouble without an Intercessor and were the "firstfruits unto God".-

The Great Multitude (Revelation 7:9) is comprised of the redeemed from all ages. This includes those who perfected Christian character amidst infidelity, the millions who were martyred for their faith, and those from every nation, kindred, and tongue who have washed their robes in the blood of the Lamb.

The Biblical Second Coming vs. The Rapture (ilk-176)

Please note that the sources do not explicitly use the term "rapture teaching," but they clearly define the nature of the Second Coming. The biblical Second Coming is described as a **highly visible, catastrophic, and glorious event**, not a secret disappearance. Christ descends upon a cloud wrapped in flaming fire, accompanied by all the heavenly angels. The heavens roll together as a scroll, massive

earthquakes strike, and the wicked, unable to stand His glory, cry out for the rocks to fall on them before being destroyed by the brightness of His coming. Simultaneously, the righteous dead are resurrected and, together with the transformed living saints, are caught up to meet the Lord.

A Worldwide Law Violating Conscience (ilk-229) Yes, a worldwide law will violate conscience at the end of time. While the United States will lead the way in enacting religious legislation, **foreign nations will follow her example**, resulting in universal Sunday legislation. The powers of earth will unite in a "universal bond of union" or confederacy to force "all, both small and great... free and bond" to observe the false sabbath. Those who refuse will first face economic boycott and eventually a universal death decree.

G08 — Christology: Jesus's Nature, Humanity, and Work

- **ilk-004** — What is the special resurrection described in Matthew 27:52-53 at the crucifixion?
- **ilk-017** — Are Christians taking Messianic prophecies out of context when applying them to Jesus?
- **ilk-048** — Did Jesus experience anything analogous to addiction during his earthly life?
- **ilk-049** — Did Jesus have an advantage over us in resisting temptation because he was divine?
- **ilk-050** — Did Jesus keep the Passover literally? What did his last Passover signify?
- **ilk-117** — Is Jesus permanently human after the ascension?
- **ilk-118** — Is Jesus the only way to salvation?
- **ilk-119** — Was Jesus born with a sinful nature?
- **ilk-120** — What is the relationship between the Jewish nation and Jesus? Did God reject Israel permanently?

- **ilk-121** — In John 5:21, who raises the dead — the Father or the Son?
 - **ilk-131** — Why is Mary's genealogical lineage missing or incomplete in scripture?
 - **ilk-140** — Is Jesus dying for your sins a substitutionary act or something else?
 - **ilk-190** — Was Christ genuinely tempted?
 - **ilk-191** — Was Jesus in effect an Adventist — did he keep the Sabbath and observe the health message?
 - **ilk-192** — Was Jesus created? What does John 1:1-3 and Colossians 1:15-17 say?
 - **ilk-193** — Was Jesus tolerant in the modern sense?
 - **ilk-209** — Where did Jesus go immediately after his ascension?
 - **ilk-211** — Where was Jesus during the three days between his death and resurrection?
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The Special Resurrection (ilk-004) At the moment of Christ's death on the cross, a mighty earthquake rent open the graves of many righteous dead who had been co-laborers with God,. When Jesus came forth from the tomb, these captives came forth with Him as the "first fruits" of His power over death,. Unlike those raised during Christ's ministry (such as Lazarus) who were still subject to death, this multitude was raised to **everlasting life**, clothed with immortality,. They went into Jerusalem, appeared to many as witnesses to the resurrection, and finally ascended to heaven with Christ as trophies of His victory,,.

Messianic Prophecies and Context (ilk-017) Christians are not taking Messianic prophecies out of context. Following Christ's resurrection, He Himself walked His disciples through Moses and all the prophets to explain how the Old Testament specifically outlined His life, suffering, death, and resurrection,. The apostles, such as Peter, Paul, and Stephen, consistently used Old Testament prophecies to prove that Jesus was the Messiah,. They demonstrated that predictions concerning His descent from David,, His birth in Bethlehem, and His substitutionary suffering—such as being

"brought as a lamb to the slaughter" and "wounded for our transgressions" (Isaiah 53)—found exact and literal fulfillment in Jesus of Nazareth,,.

Jesus, Appetite, and Addiction (ilk-048) While the sources do not use the modern term "addiction," they describe Jesus confronting the overwhelming, enslaving power of "debased appetite" on behalf of the human race. Because indulgence of appetite had been strengthening since Adam's fall, causing deep physical and moral degeneracy, Jesus endured a fast of nearly six weeks in the wilderness. He suffered the keenest pangs of hunger and "felt the overwhelming tide of woe" caused by humanity's lack of self-control. He overcame on this point to break the chains of indulgence and to prove that through His divine power, humanity can master unnatural and perverted cravings,,.

Advantage in Resisting Temptation (ilk-049) Jesus did not have an unfair advantage over us because He was divine. He "exercised in His own behalf no power which man cannot exercise". He met temptation entirely as a man, relying on faith and the word of God ("It is written") just as we must,. The sources affirm that if Christ had possessed a special power not available to man, Satan would have used it to prove his claim that humanity cannot keep God's law. Instead, Jesus proved that through faith, fallen man can lay hold of divine power and overcome every temptation,.

The Passover (ilk-050) Jesus strictly and literally kept the Passover throughout His life, beginning in His youth,. However, His final Passover marked the transition between two economies. The Passover was a shadow pointing to the deliverance from sin through the blood of "the Lamb of God",. By celebrating His last Passover and instituting the Lord's Supper in its place, He signified that the typical sacrifices were ending because He, the antitype, was about to be sacrificed,. When the Jews crucified Him, the entire system of sacrifices lost its meaning.

Permanently Human (ilk-117) Yes, Jesus is permanently human. In taking our nature, the Saviour bound Himself to

humanity by a tie that is "never to be broken". He ascended to heaven bearing a sanctified, holy humanity and "forever to retain His human nature",. God adopted human nature in the person of His Son, carrying it into the highest heaven, where He shares the throne of the universe as the "Son of man".

The Only Way to Salvation (ilk-118) Jesus is exclusively the only way to salvation. The sources assert, "There is no other way for man's salvation. 'Without me,' says Christ, 'ye can do nothing'". Because He alone possessed both divinity and humanity, He was the only one who could serve as a mediator and pay the infinite price to reconcile fallen man to God,.

Christ's Human Nature and Sin (ilk-119) Jesus took upon Himself our fallen human nature, bearing the infirmities, weaknesses, and liabilities of a race that had degenerated over four thousand years,,. However, He was "born without a taint of sin". The texts strongly caution: "Do not set Him before the people as a man with the propensities of sin... not for one moment was there in Him an evil propensity". He took man's nature, but not man's sinfulness.

Relationship with the Jewish Nation (ilk-120) Because the Jewish nation as a corporate body rejected Christ and demanded His crucifixion, they sealed their rejection of the gospel, and "Israel was divorced from God",. However, God did not permanently reject the Jewish people as individuals. The sources indicate that in the closing proclamation of the gospel, when it is presented in its fullness, many Jews will recognize Christ in the Old Testament, their slumbering faculties will be aroused, and they will accept Him as their Redeemer,,.

Raising the Dead in John 5:21 (ilk-121) In response to the Sadducees, Jesus declared that "as the Father raiseth up the dead, and quickeneth them; even so the Son quickeneth whom He will",. This affirmed that the Son possesses the very same life-giving resurrection power as the Father.

Mary's Genealogical Lineage (ilk-131) *The provided sources trace the descent of Jesus from Abraham and David, but they do not contain any information explaining why Mary's genealogical lineage is missing or incomplete in Scripture.*

Substitutionary Act (ilk-140) Christ dying for sins was completely a substitutionary act. He became man's "substitute and surety",. "He was condemned for our sins, in which He had no share, that we might be justified by His righteousness, in which we had no share. He suffered the death which was ours, that we might receive the life which was His",.

Genuinely Tempted (ilk-190) Christ was genuinely tempted. The sources explicitly state: "Unless there is a possibility of yielding, temptation is no temptation",. As a free agent, "He could be tempted, and that strongly, and could yield to the temptations". Because of His perfect holiness, His refined sensibilities made contact with evil unspeakably painful, making His suffering under temptation immensely severe.

Sabbath and Health (ilk-191) Jesus strictly kept the seventh-day Sabbath, though He actively swept away the "senseless restrictions" the Pharisees had added to it, demonstrating by His healing miracles that it is lawful to do good on God's holy day,,,. He also lived a life of strict temperance and health, denying perverted appetite and observing abstemious habits, establishing a principle that followers should not indulge in gluttony, stimulants, or narcotics,,.

Was Jesus Created? (ilk-192) Jesus was not created. He existed "from all eternity". Regarding His nature, the texts declare, "In Christ is life, original, unborrowed, underived",. If He made all things, "He existed before all things," acting as God essentially and in the highest sense.

Jesus and Tolerance (ilk-193) Jesus was infinitely compassionate to the outcast and marginalized, but He was not tolerant of sin. He freely associated with the poor, the afflicted, and the despised,. However, He "severely

denounced hypocrisy of every sort". He was despised and hated by the rulers specifically "because he would not tolerate their sins, and praise, and glorify, and flatter them".

Where Did Jesus Go Immediately After His Ascension?

(ilk-209) Immediately following His resurrection on Sunday morning, Jesus ascended to the heavenly courts to present Himself before God. He refused to receive the homage of His people until He heard from the Father directly that His sacrifice had been accepted and that His atonement was ample,.. After receiving this assurance, He returned to earth that very same day to show Himself to His disciples.

Where Was Jesus Between His Death and

Resurrection? (ilk-211) During the three days, Jesus rested in Joseph's tomb,. The sources explicitly reject the idea that His soul went to heaven during this time, stating: "The spirit of Jesus slept in the tomb with His body, and did not wing its way to heaven, there to maintain a separate existence... All that comprised the life and intelligence of Jesus remained with His body in the sepulcher",.

G09 — Salvation, Justification, Law, Grace, and the Christian Life

- **ilk-008** — Is procrastination spiritually dangerous?
- **ilk-016** — Are we born sinners? What is the Adventist view of inherited sinful nature vs. imputed guilt?
- **ilk-027** — Is Christian meditation permissible? What distinguishes biblical meditation from Eastern practices?
- **ilk-029** — Can tares be converted to wheat?
- **ilk-058** — Does God allow hardships in believers' lives?
- **ilk-076** — What is the relationship between God's law and the law of sin? How is the Romans 7-8 conflict resolved?

- **ilk-080** — Does God harden hearts? What does Pharaoh's hardened heart mean for free will?
- **ilk-081** — Does God knowing my fate mean my choices are predetermined?
- **ilk-082** — Does God leave people alone or withdraw from them?
- **ilk-088** — What does truly following Jesus require?
- **ilk-097** — What if I feel unforgiven? What does scripture say about assurance of forgiveness?
- **ilk-098** — What if I'm not living up to my baptismal vow?
- **ilk-108** — Is it wrong to question God?
- **ilk-110** — Does Last Generation Theology deny Christ's sufficiency?
- **ilk-111** — Is love a decision, a feeling, or a mindset?
- **ilk-112** — Is loving God a form of self-centered love because you want to go to heaven?
- **ilk-122** — What is the difference between legal justification (forensic) and experiential transformation?
- **ilk-127** — How do grace and law coexist for the believer?
- **ilk-134** — Can your name be removed from the Book of Life?
- **ilk-143** — Is character perfection required for salvation?
- **ilk-144** — Is it possible to live without sinning?
- **ilk-145** — What is the proper posture and attitude for prayer?
- **ilk-167** — Is it unchristian to stop struggling with a besetting sin?
- **ilk-181** — Is sin truly universal?
- **ilk-187** — What is the unforgivable sin?
- **ilk-194** — Was Judas saved?
- **ilk-195** — Are we sinners or saints? How does the NT address the believer's identity?

- **ilk-215** — Where does willpower come from? What does the Bible say about the source of moral strength?
 - **ilk-220** — Will atheists be saved?
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Procrastination (ilk-008) Procrastination is spiritually dangerous. The sources warn, "Beware of procrastination," emphasizing that putting off the work of forsaking sins and seeking purity through Jesus is a terrible danger. Delaying to yield to the Holy Spirit is actually choosing to live in sin, and what we do not overcome will eventually destroy us. "Indecision soon becomes decision in the wrong direction". "Delays are virtually defeats", and the day is fast approaching when probation will close.

Human Nature and Sin (ilk-016, ilk-181) Sin is truly universal. The Bible declares that "All have sinned, and come short of the glory of God," and the entire human family is hopelessly ruined and condemned by the law. Regarding inherited sinful nature, the sources teach that because of Adam's fall, "his posterity was born with inherent propensities of disobedience". Christ, however, "took human nature, and bore the infirmities and degeneracy of the race". While He was tempted in all points like us and took on our fallen nature, "Christ did not in the least participate in its sin," possessing no evil propensities or taint of corruption. We are not held responsible for the sins of our fathers unless we follow their evil practices.

Christian Meditation (ilk-027) Christian meditation is highly permissible and encouraged. Believers are instructed to "spend a thoughtful hour each day in contemplation of the life of Christ," taking it point by point and grasping each closing scene. Meditation upon the perfections of the Saviour, His love, and His mercy transforms the soul into His divine likeness. *While the sources do not explicitly use the term "Eastern practices,"* they warn against "the phantomizing system of the Buddhists" and condemn the "theory of mind controlling mind" as a dangerous deception originated by Satan to separate man from God. Biblical meditation is always

centered on God's Word and Christ's character, not emptying the mind or yielding it to human control.

Tares and Wheat (ilk-029) Tares cannot be converted to wheat. In the parable of the wheat and the tares, Jesus "does not point forward to a time when all the tares become wheat". They are to grow together until the harvest at the end of the world, at which point the tares will remain tares and be cast into the fire to be utterly destroyed.

Hardships and the Believer (ilk-058) God does allow hardships in believers' lives. "Trials and obstacles are the Lord's chosen methods of discipline and His appointed conditions of success". God allows His chosen ones to be placed in the furnace of affliction to refine them, remove the impurities from their character, and fit them for the heavenly temple. We are not to fret, complain, or rebel in trials, for they teach us to lean upon our Almighty Helper.

Law, Grace, and the Romans 7-8 Conflict (ilk-076, ilk-127) The law and the gospel go hand in hand in perfect harmony.. The law is a mirror that reveals man's sin, but it has no power to pardon or save the transgressor. In Romans 7, Paul states, "when the commandment came, sin revived, and I died," meaning the law exposed his sin and condemned him. The resolution is found in Christ: the law drives the sinner to the Saviour, who imputes His righteousness to the believer. The gospel does not abolish the law; rather, through faith in Christ, "obedience to every principle of the law is made possible," and "the righteousness of the law" is fulfilled in those who walk after the Spirit.

God's Sovereignty and Human Free Will (ilk-080, ilk-081, ilk-082) *While the sources do not explicitly detail Pharaoh's hardened heart, they explain that the hardening of the heart is the natural result of human choice. "Every resistance of temptation makes resistance more easy... The first resistance to the Spirit's pleading prepares the way for the second resistance. Thus the heart is hardened".* God's foreknowledge does not mean choices are predetermined. The doctrine of divine decrees unalterably fixing the

character of men is condemned as an error; "Men fail of salvation through their own willful refusal of the gift of life". God knew the conditions of the future, but "He did not make His purposes to fit circumstances" or arbitrarily predestine rebellion. God does not force the conscience. However, **God does eventually withdraw from people** if they persistently reject Him. If people turn from the truth, "He leaves them to themselves, to be filled with the fruit of their own doings". As men reject His warnings, God "withdraws His Spirit and leaves them to the deceptions which they love".

Following Jesus and Christian Identity (ilk-088, ilk-195) Truly following Jesus requires total surrender, self-denial, and obedience. "To live thus by the word of God means the surrender to Him of the whole life". "It will require a sacrifice to give yourself to God... Our will is to be yielded to Him". It requires keeping the commandments, for "the requirement under the covenant of grace is just as broad as the requirement made in Eden—harmony with God's law...". Regarding identity, believers are sinners who are pardoned and treated as saints. "In ourselves we are sinners; but in Christ we are righteous. Having made us righteous through the imputed righteousness of Christ, God pronounces us just, and treats us as just. He looks upon us as His dear children". By faith, the believer passes from being a rebel to a loyal subject, standing "faultless before God".

Assurance of Forgiveness and the Unforgivable Sin (ilk-097, ilk-187) If you feel unforgiven, you must look away from your feelings and trust God's promises. "Feeling has nothing to do with faith". The absence of happy feelings is no evidence of a lack of sanctification. Scripture promises: "If we confess our sins, He is faithful and just to forgive us our sins, and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness. 1 John 1:9. Glorious truth!". The **unforgivable sin** (the sin against the Holy Ghost) is "willfully attributing to Satan the work of the Holy Spirit". The most common manifestation of this sin is "persistently slighting Heaven's invitation to repent".

Failing Vows and Questioning God (ilk-098, ilk-108) If you are not living up to your baptismal vow, your hope is in repentance. "Those who have put on Christ by baptism... should not set up idols in their hearts," but if they have backslidden, they must return to Him with true repentance.

It is not for finite minds to question or accuse God.

"We are not to doubt His goodness because we cannot understand His providence". To admit we cannot comprehend the great truths of the Bible is simply to admit that the finite mind cannot grasp the infinite.

Christ's Sufficiency and Perfection (ilk-110, ilk-143, ilk-144) *While the sources do not explicitly use the term "Last Generation Theology,"* they emphatically uphold Christ's absolute sufficiency. "We must not think that our own grace and merits will save us; the grace of Christ is our only hope of salvation". "Christ is able to save to the uttermost because He ever liveth to make intercession for us". **Character perfection is required for salvation, but it is only possible through Christ.** "The Lord requires at this time just what He required of Adam in Eden—perfect obedience to the law of God. We must have righteousness without a flaw". However, "when, through faith in Jesus Christ, man does according to the very best of his ability... the perfection of Christ is imputed to cover the transgression". **It is possible to live without sinning through divine grace, but true Christians will never boast of it.** "Abundant grace has been provided that the believing soul may be kept free from sin". Yet, "none of the apostles or prophets ever claimed to be without sin," and anyone who claims to be sinless is deceived. True sanctification is a daily, lifelong work, not an instantaneous state.

Love, Besetting Sins, and Willpower (ilk-111, ilk-112, ilk-167, ilk-215) **Love is an active principle, not merely an emotion.** "The working out of the principle of love is true sanctification". It leads to obedience and unselfish service. Loving God merely to go to heaven is a form of selfishness; those who seek happiness by gratifying themselves "are on the wrong track". **It is unchristian to stop struggling with a besetting sin.** "Every besetting sin

must be put away. Warfare must be waged against it until it is overcome". **Willpower and moral strength come from God's Word and Spirit.** "A firm, decided will-power is not brought into the life and character, because the sacred instruction of God is not made the study, and the subject of meditation". By believing in Christ, human weakness unites with divine strength.

Legal Justification vs. Experiential Transformation

(ilk-122) Legal justification is forensic: "By Him who speaketh truth he is declared righteous. The Lord imputes unto the believer the righteousness of Christ... He transfers his sins to Jesus". It is God's act of pardoning the sinner and treating him as if he had not sinned. Experiential transformation (sanctification) is the ongoing work of the Holy Spirit renewing the heart, subduing the natural tendencies, and producing the fruit of obedience over a lifetime.

The Book of Life and the Fate of Judas and Atheists

(ilk-134, ilk-194, ilk-220) Your name can be removed from the Book of Life. Those who do not overcome, or who endeavor to conceal their sins, will be overcome by Satan and face destruction. "All who would have their names retained in the book of life, should now... afflict their souls before God by sorrow for sin". **Judas was not saved.** After betraying Christ, he felt remorse, but "there was no genuine repentance for sin, no conversion of purpose, no abhorrence of evil". *While the term "atheist" is not explicitly used,* the sources confirm that those who do not believe in Christ will not be saved. "Those who do not believe in Christ are not reconciled to God". "He that believeth not the Son shall not see life; but the wrath of God abideth on him".

Prayer Posture (ilk-145) There is a "propriety of varying postures in prayer" and one "need not always kneel". God looks with pleasure upon those who bow morning and evening, but "If we pray even when our hands are employed, the Saviour's ear is open to hear our petitions".

G10 — God: Nature, Character, and the Problem of Evil

- **ilk-044** — Why did God continue to call Jacob by his old name after changing it to Israel?
- **ilk-059** — Does God kill? How do we reconcile OT accounts of God killing with the NT revelation of a God of love?
- **ilk-084** — How are God's killing orders in the OT (Canaanite genocide, Flood, etc.) morally justified?
- **ilk-106** — Is God really a Trinity? What is the biblical basis for Trinitarian theology?
- **ilk-107** — Is God's name Jehovah or Yahweh? What does the Tetragrammaton mean?
- **ilk-182** — How did people in the OT see God if no one can see him and live?
- **ilk-208** — What was the "first light" of Genesis 1:3 if the sun wasn't created until day four?
- **ilk-213** — Which ethnic group does God favor, or does he?
- **ilk-214** — Who should we pray to — the Father, the Son, or the Spirit?
- **ilk-219** — Why is God portrayed as male in scripture?

The Re-use of Jacob's Name (ilk-044) While the sources detail that Jacob's name was changed to Israel ("a prince of God") as a commemoration of his victory of faith and the pardon of his sins at Peniel,, they do not explicitly explain *why* God continued to call him by his old name, Jacob, in subsequent interactions (such as in visions directing him to Egypt,).

Does God Kill? Reconciling Justice and Love (ilk-059, ilk-084) God does execute retributive judgment, and the sources affirm that "He will by no means clear the guilty",. However, God's act of punishment is described as His "strange act",. He takes no pleasure in the death of the wicked, but He is forced to execute judgment to preserve

the inhabitants of the earth from utter depravity and ruin,. The destruction of the wicked is ultimately an act of mercy to the universe, preventing sin from being perpetuated eternally,. Furthermore, the sources clarify that death is the inevitable result of a sinner's own choice; by choosing sin, one cuts oneself off from God, the fountain of life, and the very presence of a holy God becomes to them a consuming fire,.

Regarding the moral justification for Old Testament killing orders (like the Canaanites or the Flood), God has unlimited control over the works of His hands, and "there is no injustice in his character",. God is incredibly long-suffering. He spared the Amorites for four hundred years to give them unmistakable evidence of the true God, waiting until "the iniquity of the Amorites is not yet full",,. When their guilt reached its limit and they clung to brutal idolatry (such as burning their children in the fire), they were destroyed. Similarly, in the days of Noah, men's long lives only led them to multiply their violence and corruption; God destroyed them to cleanse the earth of moral pollution,. Unconditional pardon for such high-handed rebellion would be weakness, not benevolence, and would fill the unfallen universe with consternation,.

The Trinity and the Godhead (ilk-106) Yes, the sources explicitly affirm Trinitarian theology. There are "three living persons of the heavenly trio",. These "eternal heavenly dignitaries" are identified as God the Father, Christ the Son, and the Holy Spirit,. Christ is "God essentially, and in the highest sense," existing with the Father from all eternity,. At baptism, believers enter a covenant in the "threefold name of the Father, the Son, and the Holy Spirit," and these three great powers pledge to cooperate with the Christian in overcoming darkness,.

God's Name: Jehovah and I AM (ilk-107) The sources refer to the Supreme Being as "Jehovah, the eternal, self-existent, uncreated One",. Christ also announced Himself to Moses and the Jews under the title "I AM THAT I AM",,. The title "I AM" signifies an "eternal presence," demonstrating that the past, present, and future are alike to God. (*Note:*

The sources do not use the specific terms "Yahweh" or "Tetragrammaton," nor do they delve into their linguistic roots; you may want to independently verify the etymology of those specific scholarly terms).

Seeing God in the Old Testament (ilk-182) The Bible states that no mortal can see the unveiled glory of God and live,. To communicate with fallen humanity without consuming them, "the all-merciful God shrouded His glory in a most humble type",. He veiled His majesty in the burning bush, and in the pillar of cloud by day and fire by night,. Furthermore, it was Christ who mediated this presence. Christ was the "Angel of God's presence" who spoke to Moses and guided Israel in the wilderness, veiling the dazzling splendor of His divinity so that humanity could become acquainted with their Creator,. Even when Moses pleaded to see God's glory, God mercifully covered him in the cleft of a rock and only allowed him to see His "back parts" or subdued glory,.

The "First Light" of Genesis 1:3 (ilk-208) The sources describe that at the creative word, "light had shone out of darkness" and "the Spirit of God moved upon the face of the waters" to bring forth light,. Christ Himself is described as the one who caused this light to shine. *(Note: The texts do not provide a scientific explanation differentiating this initial light from the sun created on the fourth day, focusing instead on the fact that God's word and presence brought light into the darkness).*

God and Ethnic Favoritism (ilk-213) God is "no respecter of persons," but in every generation those who fear Him and work righteousness are accepted,. He has a "tender pity" for all and "makes no difference between white and black". While God anciently chose the Israelites as a special people, it was not for selfish exclusivity. He chose them to be depositaries of His law and light-bearers so that "through them to all the inhabitants of the earth" He might be revealed. The covenant with Abraham embraced *all* the nations of the earth. Because the Jewish nation failed this purpose, God's true Israel is now made up of all who yield themselves to Him, regardless of whether they are Jew or

Gentile,,. There is no arbitrary election where anyone is excluded; every soul is elected who chooses to obey God,.

Who Should We Pray To? (ilk-214) The sources instruct believers to address the Father *through* the mediation of the Son. Christ taught man to address the Supreme Ruler by the endearing name, "Our Father",. However, because sin separated man from God, we cannot approach Him on our own; we must "present your case to the Father through Jesus Christ". Christ stands before the eternal throne as our Advocate and High Priest, presenting our prayers as spiritual sacrifices,. Therefore, we pray to the Father in the name and merits of the Son,.

God Portrayed as Male (ilk-219) Throughout the sources, God is referred to with male pronouns (He, Him) and is characterized by His "paternal love" and "tender Fatherhood",,. He is likened to a father who pities his children,. *(Note: The provided texts do not address the theological or linguistic reasons why Scripture portrays God as male; you may need to look outside these sources to explore the biblical theology of gender and divine representation).*

G11 — Ellen White and the Spirit of Prophecy

- **ilk-012** — Does the prophetic gift continue after the apostolic age? What does Joel 2:28 and Revelation 12:17 say?
- **ilk-066** — Are all of Ellen White's writings equally inspired? What did she herself say?
- **ilk-067** — Did Ellen White condemn Christmas trees? What did she actually write?
- **ilk-068** — What is the relationship between Ellen White and the Bible? Did she claim authority above scripture?
- **ilk-126** — What did Ellen White say about life insurance?
- **ilk-205** — What is the Spirit of Prophecy? What does Revelation 19:10 mean?

- **ilk-212** — What was Jesus doing during the period after his resurrection and before his ascension?
 - **ilk-003** — [Pull questions from ilk-003 transcript when curating]
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The Prophetic Gift After the Apostolic Age (ilk-012, ilk-205) The prophetic gift was never designed to be limited to the primitive church or the apostolic age,. The Great Commission given by Christ, which promised that miraculous signs would follow believers, extends "unto the end of the world",,,. The Apostle Paul taught that spiritual gifts were "set in the church" (1 Corinthians 12:28) to perfect the saints and bring them to a unity of the faith, and these gifts will not cease until the perfect state of the immortal world is reached,,,. The rarity of these gifts over the centuries was due to the apostasy, errors, and unbelief of the church, not because God withdrew them,.

Joel 2:28 promises that in the "last days" God will pour out His Spirit upon all flesh, causing sons and daughters to prophesy, young men to see visions, and old men to dream dreams,,. While this saw a partial fulfillment at Pentecost (the "former rain"), it reaches its full accomplishment in the "latter rain" which will attend the closing work of the gospel just prior to the great and terrible day of the Lord,,,. Furthermore, Revelation 12:17 declares that the dragon will make war with the remnant (the last generation of the church), who **"keep the commandments of God, and have the testimony of Jesus Christ"**,,. Revelation 19:10 explicitly defines this "testimony of Jesus" as **"the spirit of prophecy"**,,. Therefore, the remnant church will be distinguished by the revival of the prophetic gift.

Relationship Between Ellen White and the Bible (ilk-068) Ellen White never claimed authority above the Scriptures; instead, she consistently pointed to the Bible as the "supreme authority," the "unerring standard," and the "rule of your faith and practice" by which all teachings, experiences, and spiritual manifestations must be tested,,,,,. She defined her writings as **"a lesser light to lead men and women to the greater light"**,. She explicitly stated

that her testimonies were not given to take the place of the Bible or to provide new doctrines,. Rather, because people had neglected the Word of God and failed to practice its plain teachings, God provided the testimonies to bring them back to the Bible, to simplify its great truths, and to impress its principles vividly upon the heart,,,. She even instructed ministers not to quote her writings as the primary authority to sustain their doctrinal positions, but to bring their clear proofs directly from the Word of God.

The Nature of Ellen White's Inspiration (ilk-066) Not every word spoken or letter written by Ellen White was equally inspired. When questioned if every letter she wrote under all circumstances was "as inspired as the Ten Commandments," she firmly denied it,. She clarified that the Ten Commandments were of direct divine composition, whereas the Bible—and her own writings—represent a union of the divine and the human. God inspired the *writers* with thoughts and visions, but the writers expressed those truths using their own imperfect human language and mental development,,. However, regarding her published books, articles, and testimonies of reproof, she firmly maintained that they were not merely her human opinions,. She stated: **"I do not write one article in the paper expressing merely my own ideas. They are what God has opened before me in vision"**,. She strongly warned against those who attempted to dissect her testimonies to define what was from God and what was her own human judgment, declaring that those who do this are helping the devil in his work of deception,.

Literary Assistants and the Use of Historians (ilk-003)

In the preparation of her books, Ellen White used literary assistants (like Marian Davis) to gather her previously written materials, correct grammar, and compile chapters,. However, these copy editors did not change her language, add their own thoughts, or alter the meaning of the messages; her words stood as she wrote them,,. When describing historical events, such as the Reformation, the great outlines of the controversy were shown to her in vision,. As she wrote out these scenes, she sometimes found that conscientious historians had provided perfect

descriptions of the events and facts that God had already revealed to her,. She utilized their language because it was a convenient and forceful way to present the truth, but she never intended for her writings to be used as an infallible authority on historical dates or minor chronological details,.

Christmas Trees (ilk-067) Ellen White did not condemn Christmas trees. She wrote that there is "**no particular sin in selecting a fragrant evergreen and placing it in our churches**". The sin lies in the motive for doing so and the use made of the gifts. Instead of using the tree for mere amusement or to mimic the extravagant display of the world, she advised that its boughs "be laden with the golden and silver fruit of your beneficence" and presented to God as an offering to sustain His work and help the needy.

Life Insurance (ilk-126) Ellen White counseled Sabbathkeeping Adventists not to engage in commercial life insurance,. She described it as a "worldly policy" and a "commerce with the world which God does not approve" because it weakens faith, lessens spirituality, and demonstrates a distrust of God's providence,,,. Furthermore, she pointed out that it diverts means belonging to God into the enemy's ranks instead of investing them in His cause,. Instead, she pointed believers to the "**eternal life insurance policy**" provided by Christ's sacrifice, which guarantees immortality and a life measuring with the life of God,,,,,.

Jesus Between the Resurrection and Ascension (ilk-212) During the forty days after His resurrection and before His ascension, Jesus remained with His disciples, showing Himself alive by "many infallible proofs" and speaking to them of the things "pertaining to the kingdom of God". He used this time to open their understanding to the Old Testament Scriptures, explaining in "all the prophets" the things concerning Himself. He demonstrated that He was the true sin-bearer and, having conquered death, led forth a multitude of captives from the grave as "jewels gathered from the earth" who appeared unto many in Jerusalem before ascending to heaven with Him.

G12 — Tithe and Financial Stewardship

- **ilk-030** — Can tithe money be used for personal retirement savings?
- **ilk-051** — Did Jesus pay tithe?
- **ilk-056** — Should I tithe on borrowed money?
- **ilk-074** — What does biblical financial stewardship look like beyond tithe?
- **ilk-164** — Is it acceptable to steal money in order to give it to God?
- **ilk-184** — What if the tithe is being used for hidden agendas by church leadership?
- **ilk-185** — What is the biblical basis for tithing?
- **ilk-218** — Why do we tithe — is it law, gratitude, or covenant participation?
- **ilk-225** — Is withholding tithe from a corrupt church justified?

Use of Tithe for Personal Retirement (ilk-030) Tithe money cannot be used for personal retirement savings. The sources are explicit that the tithe is sacred, reserved by God for Himself, and is to be used exclusively to sustain gospel laborers and ministers in their work,. Believers are warned: "Let none feel at liberty to retain their tithe, to use according to their own judgment. They are not to use it for themselves in an emergency, nor to apply it as they see fit",. Taking money from God's treasury to serve oneself or one's secular business is considered sacrilege,.

Did Jesus Pay Tithe? (ilk-051) The sources state that "Christ recognized the payment of tithes as a duty". Furthermore, "It was Christ who gave all the directions of the law in regard to tithes and offerings". While the texts do not detail a specific instance of Jesus paying a tithe on personal income, they emphasize that He strictly obeyed God's requirements and the laws of the land. When asked about paying the temple tribute (the annual religious contribution for the sanctuary), Jesus miraculously provided a coin to pay it for Himself and Peter, so as not to give

offense, though as the Son of God He was exempt,,,,. He also famously commanded, "Render therefore unto Caesar the things which are Caesar's; and unto God the things that are God's",,,.

Tithing on Borrowed Money (ilk-056) God specifically asks for one-tenth of all our *increase*,,,,. Since borrowed money is a debt rather than an increase or profit, the principle of tithing the increase would not apply to the principal of a loan. However, the sources offer stern warnings regarding debt and stewardship. Being in debt does not excuse a person from paying tithes on their actual increase,. The texts state that a person who finds himself in debt "should not take the Lord's portion to cancel his debts to his fellow men," as this makes him a "double debtor" who robs God,,.

Biblical Financial Stewardship Beyond the Tithe (ilk-074) True financial stewardship extends far beyond the tenth. God claims ownership of the entire universe; thus, *all* that we possess is His, and we are merely stewards,,,,. Beyond the tithe, stewardship includes:

- **Offerings:** Bringing freewill offerings, thank offerings, and trespass offerings in proportion to how God has blessed us,,,,- **The Second Tithe:** Historically, God required a second tithe used for charity, hospitality, and entertaining the Levites and the poor,,,,- **Caring for the Poor:** God's stewards are to minister to the needy, the widow, and the fatherless, treating them as representatives of Christ,,,,- **Economy and Frugality:** Christians must shun debt, extravagance, and needless luxuries, practicing strict economy so they have more means to advance God's cause and relieve suffering,,,,.

Stealing to Give to God (ilk-164) It is never acceptable to steal or use dishonest means to give money to God. The Lord declares, "I hate robbery for burnt offering",,,,,. Money obtained by overreaching in trade, fraud, or the liquor traffic is stained with blood and has the curse of God upon it,. God will not accept such offerings; they are an

abomination and an offense to Him, because He "does not want money that is obtained by overreaching or by any semblance of dishonesty",.

Withholding Tithe from a Corrupt Church or Leadership (ilk-184, ilk-225) Withholding tithe because of a lack of confidence in church leadership is **not justified**. The texts explicitly address this: "Some have been dissatisfied, and have said: 'I will not longer pay my tithe; for I have no confidence in the way things are managed at the heart of the work.' But will you rob God because you think the management of the work is not right?",. If there is mismanagement, believers are instructed to make their complaints plainly and openly to the proper authorities, but they must not withdraw from God's work or prove unfaithful,. The tithes are not the property of any man, but of God. Even if unworthy ministers receive some of the funds, no one should dare to "withhold from the treasury, and brave the curse of God". Furthermore, the recording angel notes the sincere motive of the giver, and even if the consecrated means is misapplied by leadership, the faithful donor "will not lose their reward",,.

The Biblical Basis for Tithing (ilk-185) The tithing system did not originate with Moses but reaches back to the earliest times,,.

- **Patriarchs:** Abraham paid tithes to Melchizedek (Genesis 14:20), and Jacob vowed a tenth to God at Bethel (Genesis 28:22),,,,- **The Law of Moses:** It was reaffirmed as a divine statute in Leviticus 27:30, 32, declaring "the tithe... is the Lord's",.- **The Prophets:** Malachi 3:8-10 explicitly commands bringing all the tithes into the storehouse, warning of a curse for robbery and promising a blessing for obedience,,,,,- **The New Testament:** Christ upheld the tithe when rebuking the Pharisees, saying, "these ought ye to have done" (Matthew 23:23),,. Paul also reaffirmed the principle in 1 Corinthians 9:13-14 and Hebrews 7:5, comparing the support of gospel ministers to the tithing system of the Levitical priesthood,,.

Why We Tithe: Law, Gratitude, or Covenant? (ilk-218)

We tithe for all of these reasons combined. First, it is an absolute **divine law** and a command. God simply states, "This is Mine," and withholding it is classified as embezzlement and robbery,,,. Second, it is an act of **gratitude**. It is an acknowledgment that God is the Creator, the proprietor of the earth, and the giver of health, sunshine, and rain,,,. By returning the tenth, believers express their appreciation for His mercies,,,. Finally, it is **covenant participation**. God instituted systematic benevolence for man's own benefit, to tear away his natural selfishness and counteract the dangerous sin of covetousness,,,. Continual giving "starves covetousness to death" and assimilates the believer into the image of Christ, drawing them into a collaborative covenant where they become "co-workers with Him" in the salvation of the world,,.

G13 — Diet, Health, and the Body

- **ilk-037** — Will coffee drinkers go to hell? Is consuming coffee a sin, a health issue, or a matter of conscience?
 - **ilk-057** — Does the Bible say not to eat meat? Is meat-eating sinful or merely suboptimal?
 - **ilk-065** — Did Jesus eat fish? What does this mean for the clean meat question?
 - **ilk-101** — Is coffee medically and spiritually dangerous?
 - **ilk-103** — Is fasting spiritually beneficial or dangerous?
 - **ilk-114** — Is the health message important to salvation and mission?
 - **ilk-203** — What is the Christian's responsibility for the environment?
 - **ilk-224** — Is drinking wine a salvational issue?
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Coffee: Medically, Spiritually, and Salvational (ilk-037, ilk-101) The sources categorize the drinking of tea and coffee as "a sin, an injurious indulgence, which, like other evils, injures the soul". Medically, coffee is classified as a "hurtful indulgence" and a "slow poison",. It acts as a stimulant that temporarily exhilarates and quickens the living machinery, giving a false impression of strength,. However, this is "false strength" achieved by exciting the nerves of the stomach and borrowing power from the body's future resources,. The inevitable reaction is "exhaustion, prostration, paralysis of the mental, moral, and physical powers".

Spiritually, coffee and tea benumb the brain and becloud the intellect, blunting the user's moral sensibilities so that "sin does not appear very sinful, and truth is not regarded of greater value than earthly treasure",. These stimulants foster an appetite for stronger substances like tobacco and liquor. Furthermore, the artificial excitement produced by tea and coffee often loosens the tongue at social gatherings, leading to thoughtless gossip and scandal.

Regarding salvation, the texts state that those who destroy their mental, moral, and physical health by indulgence "will lose heaven". However, God is merciful to those who indulge in pernicious habits in ignorance; but once the matter is set before them in its true light, they are "guilty before God if they continue to indulge this gross appetite".

Meat in the Bible and the Clean Meat Question

(ilk-057, ilk-065) The Bible does not universally forbid meat-eating. The original diet appointed by God in Eden consisted of fruits, grains, nuts, and vegetables; "animal food would have been included in the diet appointed man in the beginning" if it were essential to health,. God gave man no permission to eat animal food until after the Flood, when all vegetation was destroyed and God permitted Noah to eat of the clean animals preserved in the ark,. In the wilderness, God sought to elevate Israel by withholding flesh and providing manna, but He yielded to their rebellious "murmuring for the fleshpots of Egypt" and granted them meat, which brought disease and death,.

Regarding Jesus, the sources explicitly note that He ate fish. After His resurrection, He asked His disciples for meat and "did eat before them" a piece of broiled fish and a honeycomb,. He also miraculously fed the multitudes with barley loaves and small fishes, which were the "daily fare of the fisherfolk of Galilee",.

However, the fact that clean meat and fish were eaten in biblical times does not mean they are optimal today. The sources declare that "if meat eating was ever healthful, it is not safe now". Because of the increasing wickedness of man, the curse of God is upon the earth, and "animals are becoming more and more diseased",. People are continually eating flesh filled with tuberculous and cancerous germs. Furthermore, fish are often contaminated by feeding on the sewage of large cities, bringing disease to those who eat them,. While leaders are counseled "not to make the use of flesh food a test of fellowship",, persisting in a meat diet animalizes the nature, excites the lower passions, and weakens the spiritual nature, making it a highly detrimental choice,.

The Practice of Fasting (ilk-103) Fasting is highly beneficial when practiced correctly, but dangerous when taken to extremes. Medically, intemperate eating is a frequent cause of sickness, and "the very best remedy is for the patient to fast for a meal or two, that the overworked organs of digestion may have an opportunity to rest". A short period of entire abstinence, or a fruit diet for a few days, often brings great relief and recovery. Spiritually, fasting and prayer are recommended to cleanse the heart, promote a receptive frame of mind, and obtain divine wisdom when facing difficult problems,.

However, extreme or prolonged fasting is spiritually and physically dangerous. The sources warn an individual: "I think that you have erred in fasting two days. God did not require it of you... You will surely decrease in strength and your mind become unbalanced". Believers are warned against a "pharisaical religion" where unbalanced minds impose privations and fasting upon themselves to earn merit. Christ endured a forty-day fast to break the power of

appetite for the human race, but believers are explicitly told, "You are not called upon to fast forty days... There would be no virtue in such a fast".

Salvation, Mission, and the Health Message (ilk-114)

The health message is of paramount importance to salvation and the mission of the church. The sources declare that health reform is "as closely connected with the third angel's message as the hand is with the body",. It is the Lord's chosen "entering wedge" to overcome prejudice, break down barriers, and open doors for the entrance of present truth,. As believers restore the physical health of the public, the way is prepared to minister to their spiritual maladies. Regarding personal salvation, the body is the temple of the Holy Spirit, and "it is not possible for us to glorify God while living in violation of the laws of life",. Indulgence of appetite stupefies the conscience, benumbs the intellect, and makes the sanctification of the body and spirit impossible,. Thus, obeying the laws of health is a divine requirement to prepare a people to stand without fault before the throne of God.

Environmental Responsibility (ilk-203) While the sources do not extensively use modern terminology for environmentalism, they establish the Christian's responsibility to respect and care for the natural world. God's original plan was for man to subsist on the products of the earth, and "He gave to Adam charge of the garden, to dress it, and to care for it". The destruction of the earth is tied directly to human sin; the text states that "the curse of God is upon the earth, because man has cursed it". Furthermore, there is specific counsel against the needless destruction of nature: "Light was given that there is health in the fragrance of the pine, the cedar, and the fir... Let not such trees be ruthlessly cut down Let them live".

Drinking Wine as a Salvational Issue (ilk-224) Drinking intoxicating wine is unequivocally a salvational issue. The Scriptures declare that "no drunkard shall inherit the kingdom of God". God has strictly forbidden the use of intoxicating beverages, not as an exercise of arbitrary authority, but to save men from degradation and ruin. Even

so-called "milder" drinks like cider and sweet wine are highly dangerous, as they awaken a taste for stronger stimulants, pervert the character, and lay the foundation of the drinking habit,. The Christian standard regarding all alcoholic drinks is "Touch not; taste not; handle not".

G14 — Church Life, Gender, Ministry, Marriage, and Family

- **ilk-011** — Are drums acceptable in Christian worship?
- **ilk-031** — Can women give sermons or preach in church?
- **ilk-032** — Is it sinful for women to wear pants?
- **ilk-038** — Is cross-dressing sinful?
- **ilk-041** — How should believers deal with difficult or hypocritical church members?
- **ilk-055** — What happens when a believer disregards clear biblical principles?
- **ilk-089** — How do I get involved in ministry?
- **ilk-090** — How do I honor parents who are nominal or fake Christians?
- **ilk-099** — Is artificial insemination consistent with God's design for creation?
- **ilk-104** — Is God against polygamy?
- **ilk-133** — Must Christians marry? Is celibacy a higher calling in scripture?
- **ilk-157** — Can people with disabilities serve God fully?
- **ilk-163** — Is a stay-at-home father unbiblical?
- **ilk-166** — Is being single at 30 a problem?
- **ilk-198** — Is wearing a hat in church a sin?
- **ilk-206** — What should a Christian do during a divorce?
- **ilk-222** — Will wearing jewelry prevent someone from going to heaven?
- **ilk-226** — Should women be ordained as ministers?

- **ilk-227** — Is it wrong for a parent to prioritize work over parenting?
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Drums and Noise in Worship (ilk-011) Drums and loud, boisterous noise are not acceptable in Christian worship. The sources describe the use of a "bedlam of noise" with drums, music, and dancing as an "invention of Satan" designed to shock the senses, confuse the mind, and cover up his deceptive methods , , , . While musical instruments like the harp and cymbal are highly appropriate when skillfully and solemnly handled , , God's work is to be characterized by calmness, dignity, and godly fear, not a carnival of noise , , .

Women in Ministry and Ordination (ilk-031, ilk-226) Women are highly encouraged to participate in ministry, give Bible readings, and even speak to congregations , , , . The sources note that women can reach classes of people that men cannot, and that there are women who are doing "just as efficient work as the ministers" and taking the Bible to address the congregation when ministers are away , , . However, regarding formal ordination as ministers, the sources state there is no explicit encouragement from the author's pen for "the formal and official ordination of women to the gospel ministry" . She did, however, strongly recommend that women be set apart for visiting the sick and poor by "prayer and laying on of hands" (a deaconess-type work) , , and she vigorously insisted that women laboring in the gospel should be paid wages proportionate to ordained ministers , , .

Cross-dressing and Women in Pants (ilk-032, ilk-038) Cross-dressing and women wearing men's clothing are described as a sin and an abomination. God designed a plain distinction between the dress of men and women, and reversing this order causes confusion and an increase in crime , , , . While a "reform dress" advocating for shorter skirts worn over pants (the "American costume") was introduced during this era, it was explicitly condemned in the texts as immodest and wholly unfitted for the followers

of Christ, with warnings that adopting such styles would destroy the church's influence , , , .

Church Discipline and Disregard for Principles

(ilk-041, ilk-055) When dealing with difficult or erring members, believers must strictly follow Christ's rule in Matthew 18: go to the person alone in a spirit of meekness and love, rather than gossiping or exposing their faults to others , , , . If they do not listen, take one or two others , . If a member persistently disregards clear biblical principles and refuses all efforts by the church to reclaim them, the church has the solemn responsibility to separate them from fellowship and remove their names from the books , , . To retain defiant sinners in the church is considered an insult to the God of heaven . Furthermore, believers are **strictly forbidden from taking lawsuits against fellow church members to civil courts**; they should rather suffer fraud than publicly disgrace the church before the world , , , .

Getting Involved in Ministry (ilk-089) Every Christian is born into the kingdom of God as a missionary , . You can get involved by taking up the duties lying directly in your pathway, rather than waiting for a grand public role , . "Do not pass by the little things, and look for a large work. You might do successfully the small work... Take hold wherever you see that there is work to be done" , . This includes engaging in personal evangelism, distributing tracts and literature, giving Bible readings, doing canvassing (colporteur) work, and living out your faith faithfully in your secular business or trade , , , .

Honoring Unbelieving Parents (ilk-090) The command to honor your father and mother is binding upon children of all ages, even if the parents are unbelieving or disagreeable , , , . Children must care for their parents in old age and show them love and tenderness , . The only exception is if an unbelieving parent's commands directly contradict the requirements of Christ; in that case, the child must obey God and trust the consequences to Him .

Hats and Jewelry (ilk-198, ilk-222) Wearing a neat, plain hat (like a straw or silk bonnet) in church is not a sin, as

long as it avoids extremes and displays . However, wearing jewelry, gold, pearls, or engaging in the "idolatry of dress" is a serious salvational issue. Extravagant dress and jewelry foster pride, stifle the desire to do good, and represent a moral disease , , . The sources warn that those who cling to these forbidden ornaments and refuse to repent will not enter the new earth , . Even the wearing of a wedding ring is discouraged as an unnecessary conformity to worldly custom . True adorning must be the inward grace of a meek and quiet spirit .

Prioritizing Work Over Parenting (ilk-227) It is entirely wrong for parents to prioritize work over parenting. In no case are parents to let business, or even supposed religious duties and public ministry, absorb their time and talents to the neglect of their children , , . The mother's first duty is to her home, and a father must not allow business matters to prevent him from taking an equal share in the training of the children , .

(Please note: The provided sources do not contain specific information regarding artificial insemination [ilk-099], whether God is against polygamy [ilk-104], whether celibacy is a higher calling than marriage [ilk-133], the theology of people with disabilities serving God [ilk-157], the biblical status of a stay-at-home father [ilk-163], whether being single at 30 is a problem [ilk-166], or specific behavioral steps a Christian should take during a divorce proceeding [ilk-206]. You may want to independently verify these specific topics outside of the provided texts.)

G15 — Social Ethics, Hard Cases, Bible, and Hermeneutics

- **ilk-006** — Is abortion permissible in extreme circumstances (rape, life of mother, severe fetal defect)?
- **ilk-007** — Does the OT condone abuse of women?
- **ilk-021** — What does the Bible say about black slavery?

- **ilk-023** — What does "the blood cries out" mean? What is the significance of Abel's blood in Genesis 4:10?
- **ilk-035** — Does Christianity keep people in poverty?
- **ilk-036** — Should Christians be involved in competitive sports?
- **ilk-052** — Did Lot's wife have a name?
- **ilk-053** — Did the Catholic Church compile the Bible?
- **ilk-062** — Does the Book of Jasher exist, and is it scripture?
- **ilk-071** — Is there evidence for evolution in the Bible?
- **ilk-075** — Is the flat earth a salvational issue?
- **ilk-092** — How old is the earth?
- **ilk-094** — How should a Christian study the Bible?
- **ilk-095** — How was Adam made in the image of God?
- **ilk-100** — Is the Christmas offering pagan?
- **ilk-105** — Is God against socialism?
- **ilk-109** — Is the King James Version the only reliable Bible?
- **ilk-123** — What are "the keys to heaven"? What did Jesus mean in Matthew 16:19?
- **ilk-136** — Should Christians own or use guns?
- **ilk-147** — How do we reach people who have never heard the gospel?
- **ilk-152** — Does God ever sanction sacrificial killing?
- **ilk-153** — Why was a bull sacrificed instead of a lamb in certain OT contexts?
- **ilk-158** — Is shouting while sharing the message appropriate or counterproductive?
- **ilk-165** — What is the STEPHANOS — the crown of victory?
- **ilk-170** — Does the Bible contradict itself?

- **ilk-183** — Does "Thou shalt not kill" prohibit all killing, including capital punishment and war?
- **ilk-189** — Was Adam present when Eve was tempted?
- **ilk-196** — Is killing insects or cockroaches sinful?
- **ilk-199** — Are common wedding traditions (white dress, rings, etc.) pagan in origin?
- **ilk-204** — Who or what is the Bride of the Lamb?
- **ilk-210** — Where is God's kingdom now?

Based on the provided sources and our conversation history, here are the answers to your queries regarding social ethics, hard cases, the Bible, and hermeneutics.

Please note that several of your specific questions—**abortion (ilk-006), Lot's wife's name (ilk-052), the Catholic Church compiling the Bible (ilk-053), the Book of Jasher (ilk-062), the Christmas offering (ilk-100), socialism (ilk-105), the King James Version (ilk-109), the "keys to heaven" (ilk-123), owning guns (ilk-136), bull vs. lamb sacrifices (ilk-153), the STEPHANOS crown (ilk-165), Adam's presence at Eve's temptation (ilk-189), the origin of wedding traditions (ilk-199), the identity of the Bride of the Lamb (ilk-204), and the current location of God's kingdom (ilk-210)**—are not addressed in the provided sources.

Here is the comprehensive information on the topics that are covered:

Hermeneutics and the Bible

How to Study the Bible (ilk-094) A Christian should study the Bible daily with a humble, prayerful heart, seeking to know God's revealed will rather than trying to prove a preconceived theory. Instead of relying on human wisdom or the opinions of learned men, the student must compare "scripture with scripture" to find the true weight of evidence. We are to accept the Bible as the unerring guide and the literal voice of God.

Does the Bible Contradict Itself? (ilk-170) No. The teachings of God's Word on important points are "neither obscure nor contradictory; they may be understood by common minds". While skeptics claim to find contradictions between science and revelation, the sources affirm that "rightly understood, they are in perfect harmony".

Evolution and the Age of the Earth (ilk-071, ilk-092) There is no evidence for evolution in the Bible; in fact, the sources strongly condemn it. The theory that attributes the origin of man to an "ascending line of germs, mollusks, and quadrupeds" is rejected as false science. The assumption that creation took thousands or millions of years is labeled "infidelity in its most insidious... form". The Bible teaches that God created the world in six literal, 24-hour days, and the sources affirm the earth has a history of "six thousand years".

The Flat Earth (ilk-075) The sources do not treat the shape of the earth as a salvational issue or point of debate. They simply accept a spherical earth, noting that "God made His Sabbath for a round world; and when the seventh day comes to us in that round world, controlled by the sun that rules the day, it is the time in all countries and lands to observe the Sabbath".

Social Ethics

Black Slavery (ilk-021) The religion of the Bible "recognizes no caste or color". God's eighth commandment ("Thou shalt not steal") explicitly "condemns manstealing and slave dealing". The sources state that the Lord looked with sadness upon the "colored race in slavery," noting they had been "educated in crime, degraded, and oppressed," and asserts their God-given "right to the blessings of freedom".

Poverty (ilk-035) Christianity does not keep people in poverty. In God's original plan for Israel, every family was provided a home on the land to encourage an industrious, self-supporting life, preventing "extremes of wealth or poverty". Furthermore, God's Word "sanctions no policy that

will enrich one class by the oppression and suffering of another".

Abuse of Women (ilk-007) While the sources do not explicitly discuss whether the Old Testament *condones* abuse, they strongly condemn men who mistreat women. They state that lustful men whose passions force women to lives of "hardship, pain, and suffering" could more rightly "be called brutes" than husbands.

Competitive Sports (ilk-036) While modern competitive sports are not directly named, the sources contrast "Manual Labor Versus Games," indicating that God's plan involves "contented industry" and physical labor rather than spending time on idle games or frivolous amusements.

Hard Cases & Moral Dilemmas

Thou Shalt Not Kill vs. Capital Punishment and War (ilk-183) The sixth commandment prohibits all acts of injustice that shorten life, as well as hatred, revenge, and "wars of conquest". However, it does not universally prohibit God-ordained capital punishment or divine warfare. God Himself attached the death penalty to willful murder and commanded Moses and the Israelites to wage war against wicked nations like the Midianites.

Sacrificial Killing (ilk-152) God commanded the sacrifice of animals to typify the coming sacrifice of Christ. However, He absolutely condemned the *human* sacrifices practiced by heathen nations (such as passing children through the fire), classifying these as satanic cruelty and a violation of the sixth commandment.

Killing Insects (ilk-196) Killing annoying or destructive insects is not sinful. The idea that "nothing that has life should be killed, not even insects" is rebuked as a false, fanatical teaching. God gave no such message; believers are told to destroy pests to preserve themselves and their possessions from harm.

Abel's Blood Crying Out (ilk-023) The phrase "the blood cries out" is used to describe the guilt of taking a life or leading someone else into sin. Just as the voice of Abel's

blood cried to God from the ground against Cain, the ruin of any victim led astray will cry unto God against the one who corrupted them.

Evangelism & Theology

Reaching the Unreached (ilk-147) Christians have a solemn obligation to reach the "millions upon millions of human souls ready to perish" who have never heard of Christ's love. However, God's judgment is merciful toward those who die in ignorance. His test for the heathen is different than for those with great light: "He accepts from those in heathen lands a phase of righteousness which does not satisfy Him when offered by those of Christian lands. He does not require much where much has not been bestowed".

Adam Made in the Image of God (ilk-095) Adam was created as a "counterpart of God". Being made in God's image meant that "his nature was in harmony with the will of God, his mind capable of comprehending divine things. His affections were pure; his appetites and passions were under the control of reason".

Shouting While Sharing the Message (ilk-158) While "shouting" is not extensively detailed, the sources emphasize that God's work should be "quiet, calm, unpretending". Effective speaking requires bringing home truths with simple language rather than producing an "ecstasy of feeling" or sensationalism.